```
<PackageReference Include="Microsoft.AspNetCore.TestHost" Version="7.0.0"/>
```

In a typical ASP.NET Core app, you create a `HostBuilder` in your `Program` class; configure a web server (Kestrel); and define your application's configuration, services, and middleware pipeline (using a Startup file). Finally, you call `Build()` on the `HostBuilder` to create an instance of an `IHost` that can be run and that will listen for requests on a given URL and port.

NOTE All this happens behind the scenes when you use the minimal hosting `WebApplicationBuilder` and `WebApplication` APIs. I have an in-depth post exploring the code behind `WebApplicationBuilder` and how it relates to `HostBuilder` on my blog at http://mng.bz/a1mj.

The Test Host package uses the same `HostBuilder` to define your test application, but instead of listening for requests at the network level, it creates an `IHost` that uses in-memory request objects, as shown in figure 36.1.

